

Visualization and Storytelling

[Lecture-1]

What is Data Communication?

- It is the process of translating data into visuals to communicate insights.
 - charts
 - graphs
 - Infographics.

- Goal: Quickly graphs, patterns, trends and key messages.

Insight
↓
Already there
in data
↓
easy visually.

- Depending on the audience we should make visuals.
schools vs college / PhDs.

Eg: A COVID "Flatten the curve" chart communicated risk more effectively than Tables of number.

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We have not change the data
just changed starting point.

③ Efficiency :

- Visual should reduce cognitive load.
quick to understand.
- Highlight the main message
- Use the "data-to-ink ratio" principle.



Don't over use ink → junky
(or)

Under use ink → missing info

Eg: Piechart with same shades of
color

(vs)

multi-color piechart - ✓

④ Consistency :

- Stick to same Format ~~or~~ or conventions
- Consistent scales, colors or symbols across multiple visuals.

Eg:

Blue = sales
Blue of profits
in the same
presentation } Bad.

⑤ Audience Awareness :

- Design with audience's needs in mind.
- Scientist need precision → detailed axis labels, error bars
- Executive need quick insights → High-level, low info chart compared to scientists

• Journalists need accessibility → simple
visuals, explanatory captions

tory captions

↑
[simplest.]
↓
as the audience

is common man

From diff background.